

# Sprout Social: a Chicago HQ with A-level network intent, after a 20% cut

Account entry plan for Spencer Refer | Prepared Thursday, October 1, 2026 | Sources: HubSpot, Lemlist, ZoomInfo, Apollo

|                                             |                                                              |                                        |                                                                                         |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 94<br>Networking/Telecom intent, audience A | 91<br>Data Center intent, audience A                         | -20%<br>workforce cut announced Sep 15 | 0<br>replies so far                                                                     |
| STAGE<br>Prospect. No deal.                 | RUNNING NOW<br>CTF ENT - Leaders (Mason Proud), added Sep 30 | LAST TOUCH<br>Sep 30: enrollment       | NEXT STEP<br>Tue Oct 6: email Megan Bacani (Senior Engineering Manager, Infrastructure) |

## Bottom line

Sprout Social is a Chicago SaaS company (about 1,360 people, **131 S Dearborn**). In September ZoomInfo showed **Networking/Telecom 94 and Data Center 91 (both audience A)** and Cloud 95. On Sep 15 it **announced a 20% workforce cut** to remove layers. Expect cost scrutiny, so frame Crosstown as owner-direct pricing and resilience, not an upgrade. Contacts: **Mason Proud (Director of IT and Automation)** is already enrolled; Apollo added **Megan Bacani (Senior Engineering Manager, Infrastructure)** and **Alan Boyce (CTO)**.

## What Sprout is, in one analogy

Sprout is cutting the household budget. Don't sell a new car; show them a cheaper, safer route to work.

## Signals worth citing

| Signal                                       | Source          | So what for the opener         |
|----------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------|
| Net/Telecom 94 (A), DC 91 (A), Cloud 95 (B)  | ZoomInfo intent | Network and facility research. |
| ~20% workforce reduction (Sep 15)            | ZoomInfo scoop  | Cost focus.                    |
| Engineering roles at a 9-month high (Sep 26) | ZoomInfo scoop  | Still building product.        |

## Work already in motion

One enrollment.

| When   | Channel / campaign | What happened                               | Read         |
|--------|--------------------|---------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Sep 30 | CTF ENT - Leaders  | Mason Proud (Director of IT and Automation) | No reply yet |

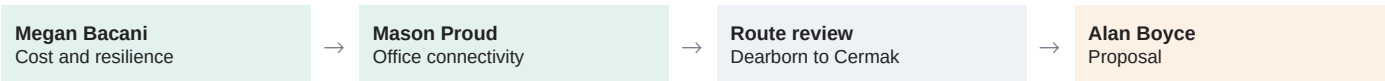
## Who to reach, in order

| Contact      | Title (source)                                      | Where   | Why they matter      | Status / email                                          |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------|---------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Megan Bacani | Senior Engineering Manager, Infrastructure (Apollo) | Chicago | Owns infrastructure. | Not contacted. megan.bacani@sproutsocial.com (verified) |
| Mason Proud  | Director of IT and Automation (HubSpot)             | Chicago | Corporate IT.        | Leaders, Sep 30                                         |
| Alan Boyce   | CTO (Apollo)                                        | Chicago | Sponsor.             | Not contacted. Hold                                     |

## Not worth chasing for this goal

Marketing and product hiring.

## How the access path should run



## Messages, by contact

**1. Megan Bacani** Senior Engineering Manager, Infrastructure

*Why them: Infrastructure owner.*

**Channel:** Email **Tue Oct 6** | **Subject:** Owner-direct fiber from 131 S Dearborn

Megan, Crosstown owns its underground fiber in Chicago, so there's no carrier markup. We're on-net at the cloud on-ramps at 350 E Cermak, a short run from Dearborn. If you're looking at network cost or resilience this quarter, I can show the map in 20 minutes.

## The plan

| When           | Move                                       | Notes |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------|-------|
| Tue Oct 6      | Email Megan Bacani.                        | -     |
| Thu Oct 8      | Follow up with Mason Proud (office angle). | -     |
| Week of Oct 19 | Goal: intro call.                          | -     |

## What progress looks like (for management)

| By     | Milestone       | How we will know |
|--------|-----------------|------------------|
| Oct 16 | Reply           | Logged           |
| Nov 6  | Intro call held | Meeting logged   |

## Guardrails

- Be sensitive to the layoff; lead with savings and simplicity.
- Credits used: ZoomInfo company and signals for 1 company; 2 Apollo person enrichments.

## Sources

HubSpot contacts and notes (Sep 30); Lemlist CTF ENT Leaders; ZoomInfo intent and scoops; Apollo.